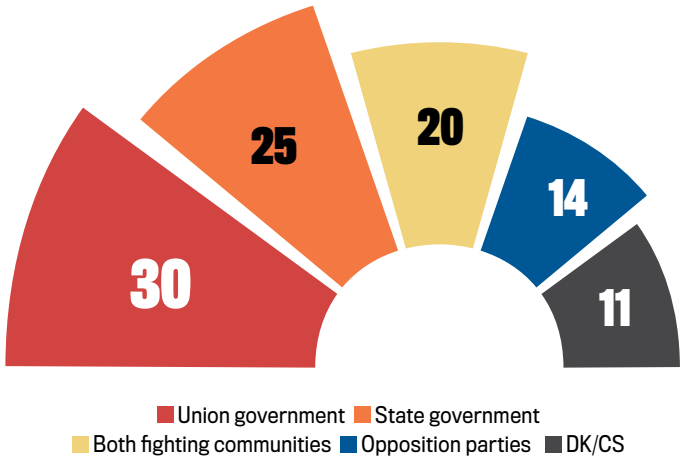
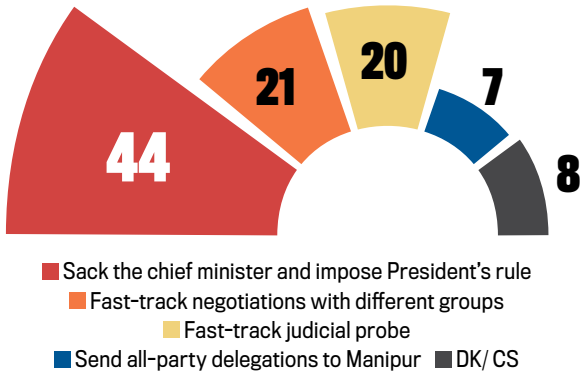
Q. Who is responsible for the ethnic clashes continuing for nearly three months in Manipur?



Most blame the Centre for the dire situation in Manipur

Q. What should the Union government do on priority to resolve the Manipur crisis?



A majority wants imposition of President's rule to end the crisis in Manipur

More than anything, the MOTN survey captures the continuing personal popularity of Narendra Modi and the wide endorsement his prime ministership elicits. When asked to assess Modi's performance as prime minister, 62.7 per cent rated it as good or outstanding in the current survey. The figure may not be as high as the 71.6 per cent Modi polled in January 2023, and way below the peak of 78 per cent in August 2020. But it marks a healthy median between the extremes marked by Covid. If that crest came before the pandemic's full impact was felt by India, the nadir of 54 per cent came right after, in August 2021. Otherwise, Modi has maintained approval ratings above 60 per cent throughout his second innings beginning May 2019.

That is a commendable record, and one inextricably bound up with his personal popularity. Asked who is best suited to be India's prime minister in 2024, a majority (52.3 per cent) give Modi the thumbs-up. His ratings have been a high 50 per cent-plus in the past four MOTNs, a remarkable recovery from the 24 per cent they had plummeted to amid the Covid-era devastation of August 2021. The NDA government's performance gets an endorsement too, with 58.7 per cent saying they are satisfied or very satisfied on that score. Though a drop of more than 10 percentage points from the January 2023 MOTN, anything above 50 is good going for a government that has been in the saddle for more than nine years. The BJP will stand to benefit the most if they can turn the coming Lok Sabha election into a presidential-style contest in which it will be Modi vs the Rest. Asked why they would vote for the BJP, 44 per cent of the respondents said it would be because of Modi, in contrast to the 21.7 per cent who chose development as the reason. Interestingly, only 14.3 per cent said they would vote for the BJP for its espousal of Hindutva and a mere 8.2 per cent for its welfare schemes. Another MOTN finding underlines why it pays for the BJP to have Modi as its trump card. The gap between him and his nearest rival Rahul Gandhi is a huge 36.5 percentage points, as only 15.8 per cent think the Congress scion is best

